



Client Services & Information



Guidestar
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Tel 9994 3345
Contact.us@guidestarlife.com.au
www.guidestarlife.com.au

About Guidestar

Guidestar works with people and/or families experiencing a combination of disability, mental health concerns, or other issues.

We are passionate about empowering people to assert their rights as consumers and assume their role as equal citizens within their chosen communities.

Guidestar Life Pty Ltd (**Guidestar™**) is a **NDIS registered**, values based organisation committed to working alongside individuals and families to overcome barriers, achieve positive change and realise aspirations.

We are a skilled, experienced and passionate group of people providing person-centred services and we assist people and their families to evaluate what is currently working and not working to achieve meaningful outcomes.

Vision

Working together to realise potential and attain optimal wellbeing.

Purpose

To provide quality, sustainable and responsive services that uphold human rights, create opportunities, promote health and empower people to make their own choices.

We do this through:

- Working together with people experiencing vulnerability, complexity and trauma;
- Working alongside individuals, families and carers;
- Partnering with organisations to achieve best possible outcomes;
- Demonstrating best possible practice; and
- Addressing and overcoming barriers to community inclusion.

In the spirit of Reconciliation, Guidestar acknowledges Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples as the Traditional Owners and Custodians of this country, with unique cultures, languages and spiritual relationships to the land and seas. We pay our respect to them, their cultures and customs, and to Elders both past and present.

Guidestar is committed to inclusive communities.



Values

Relationships

We value relationships first and foremost. Establishing ethical and professional relationships is central to our work and practice.

Respect

We are respectful and caring in all our dealings.

Diversity

We respect and acknowledge the skills and perspectives that people may bring through gender, race, culture, ethnicity, disability, age, sexual orientation, gender identity, intersex status or other difference.

Innovation

We are bold and imaginative. We thrive on opportunities to work collectively on complex issues and deliver breakthrough results. We apply our creativity across all aspects of our business and in the way we interact with people.

Thought Leadership

We share knowledge and ideas. Our directions are guided by contemporary theory and thinking, research and evidence-based practice.

Guiding Principles

Integrity

We do what we say and believe in honest, transparent, ethical communication and conduct.

Person-Centred

Our services are designed to respond to the needs and wishes of each individual.

Independence

Our services are designed to enable the greatest level of independence possible and the enjoyment of a lifestyle that reflects individual choice.

Partnership

We collaborate and partner to design solutions that work for people and organisations.

Safety

We are committed to the health and wellbeing of people by providing safe psychological and physical environments.

‘Nothing about us without us’

We are committed to self-determination and choice.

Confidentiality

We will maintain confidentiality unless disclosure is required under the law.

Services for People with Multiple and Complex Needs

Positive Behaviour Support

Positive Behaviour Support is an evidence-based approach to supporting people with intellectual and other disabilities who use behaviours of concern. Guidestar Clinicians work within a human rights framework and, building on an evidence-based approach focus on increasing a person's quality of life and decreasing the frequency and severity of their behaviours of concern.

Our Services Include:

- Sensory, psychological, ecological and functional behavioural assessments
- Training and education
- Development and review of Behaviour Support Plans
- Individual skills training and development of specialised intensive support interventions

Specialist Support Coordination

Assisting people and their supporters to find and connect with the services and providers that support their goals.

The NDIS describes Specialist Support Coordination as:

The provision of Support Coordination within a specialist framework necessitated by specific high level risks in the participant's situation. This support is time limited and focuses on addressing barriers and reducing complexity in the support environment, while assisting the participant to connect with supports and build capacity and resilience. It may also involve development of an intervention plan which will be put in place by disability support workers.

Individualised Assessment

Guidestar provides comprehensive and individualised psychological assessments to improve clinical evaluation, inform intervention, and guide therapy.

Our assessment process includes clinical interviews, file reviews, observations, meetings with the individual to be assessed, his/her carers, family, support workers and significant others. If applicable, psychological testing may also be administered as part of the assessment process.

Therapeutic Services

Guidestar Therapy Services aim to provide evidence-based interventions for people struggling with any kind of issues in their life. We can provide a safe, confidential and respectful place where people can explore where they are in their life and where they want to be. Our therapists view people as the experts on their own life and their role is to guide the person through a process of greater self-awareness and understanding. We work to develop a cooperative partnership that aims to empower people by providing greater insight into their strengths and assisting them to develop key skills.

Rights & Responsibilities

Under the Victorian Charter of Human Rights and Responsibilities, we uphold your right to Freedom, Respect, Equality and Dignity.

The Disability Act (2006) protects your rights and ensures that people with a disability have the same rights and responsibilities as everyone else does.

Your rights

You have the right to;

- Be treated with dignity and respect
- Go to places and learn how to do new things
- Make decisions about your life, or choose a support person to help you make these decisions
- Have information provided to you in a way you understand
- Use all services within your community
- Make a complaint about services that you are not happy with

Your responsibilities

You have responsibilities that include;

- Treating staff with dignity and respect and uphold their right to a safe work environment
- Communicating with each other about your services and changes in circumstances
- Meeting obligations in terms of payments or appointments, or letting us know if you need to reschedule services

Our responsibility to you

We have a right to ensure the services we provide meet certain standards, including;

- Supporting and upholding your rights
- Providing you with good quality services
- Assisting you to make choices about your life and assist you to be as independent as possible
- Providing you opportunities to do things within your community
- Providing you information in a way that you understand
- Providing you information about our service and what you can do if you're not happy with us

Your Privacy

What information we collect

We collect information that helps us plan the support you require. Information we need to collect may include your name, date of birth, contact details, information about your health and how we can support you and the people around you to keep safe.

Who can see your information?

Your information will only be seen by the professionals supporting you from Guidestar. If we need to share information with others outside of this support network, we will talk to you first. There may be times that we need to share information without your consent to keep you and others safe. These times will be due to an emergency or if we have to disclose under the law.

While the information assists us to best support you, you do have the right to inform us what information we can share and who we can share this with. You can change or cancel your consent to share information at any time.

Protecting your information

We treat and store your information in a way that it is secure and confidential as the privacy of your information is protected by the law.

Accessing your information

You have the right to look at the information we have about you, unless the law says that we cannot show you. You can access your information and ask us to correct or update the information if we have it wrong. If you would like to access your information, we will require you to make a request in writing, which will be responded to you within 30 days.

Questions or complaints

If there are any questions that you may have, or if you have a complaint or concern about how we handle your information, please contact us at Guidestar and we will work with you to ensure the concern is resolved quickly.

Guidestar's Privacy Policy Statement

Guidestar is required to comply with the Australian Privacy Principles (APP) in the Commonwealth *Privacy Act, 1988* and the Health Privacy Principles in the *Victorian Health Records Act, 2001*. Guidestar, in adopting best practice, also seeks to comply with the *Victorian Privacy and Data Information Act, 2014*.

As Guidestar provides services to clients accessing the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS), Guidestar will be operating across Commonwealth and Victorian privacy principles. Guidestar will therefore be required to adhere to the Australian Privacy Principles and the Health Privacy Principles (Victorian) in relation to health information.

In situations where a client's health information is protected by both Commonwealth and Victorian privacy principles, then Guidestar must adhere to the Commonwealth principle as this takes precedence.

As Guidestar is a disability services provider operating in accordance with the *Victorian Disability Act, 2006* (as the vehicle to achieve compliance with the NDIS Quality Safeguards), for these specific matters only, the *Victorian Disability Act, 2006* will take precedence.

On 13 February, 2017 the Australian Parliament passed the Privacy Amendment (Notifiable Data Breaches) Act 2017 (NDB scheme). As a result, from 22 February 2018 all entities covered by the Australian Privacy Principles (APPs) have clear obligations to report eligible data breaches. The NDB scheme only applies to data breaches involving personal information that are likely to result in serious harm to any individual affected. Guidestar is required to take all reasonable steps to ensure an assessment is completed within 30 days.

Advocacy

What is advocacy?

Advocacy promotes and protects the rights of a person or group of people with a disability.

Self-advocacy

Self-advocacy is the ability to speak up for yourself about the choices that are important to you and affect your life.

What we can do to assist

If you do not have someone to advocate on your behalf, we can support you to access advocacy services and ensure your rights are upheld.

Victorian advocacy services

If you require any assistance, there are a number of disability advocacy and self-advocacy services available.

A full list of these services and further information about advocacy can be found on the Disability Advocacy Resource Unit website at <http://www.daru.org.au/find-an-advocate>.

VALID is the peak state-wide advocacy body representing and supporting adult (18+) Victorians with an intellectual disability. VALID may be able to help with things like:

- Difficulties with community-based programs
- Access to or issues within disability accommodation services
- Issues regarding disability respite services
- Concerns about or working better with disability staff support
- The Department of Health & Human Services
- Linking with or accessing suitable healthcare facilities
- NDIS matters

VALID can also support people when registering complaints with the Disability Services Commissioner or working with the Office of the Public Advocate regarding Administration and Guardianship matters. The VALID website is <https://www.valid.org.au/>

Client Safety & Wellbeing

At Guidestar, all employees and contractors have a responsibility to contribute to the achievement of a safe environment for all clients. This will be underpinned by the Guidestar Clinical and Practice Governance Framework and Quality Policy of a 'just and trusting' culture of openness to identifying and learning from mistakes, rather than focusing on and blaming individuals.

Your rights

Everyone has the right to live their life safely and free from abuse, violence, neglect and fear, regardless of age, disability, culture or religion.

Definition and types of abuse and neglect

Abuse is when someone tries to take away your rights, even if they don't realise they are hurting you. Abuse is when someone does or says things to you that make you scared or upset. This can include sexual and physical abuse, neglect, discrimination, harassment, bullying and humiliation.

There are different types of abuse, some of these include:

Physical Abuse	When someone hurts your body (such as hitting or restraining you).
Sexual Abuse	When someone makes you do sexual things you don't want to do.
Emotional Abuse	When someone does things to hurt your feelings.
Financial Abuse	When someone takes your belongings or spends your money.
Neglect	When you don't get the support and care to meet your basic needs.

Our responsibilities to you

- Provide clear direction for employees for the promotion of a safe environment that supports wellbeing and the prevention of abuse and neglect for all consumers.
- Outline how a safe environment will be provided for all clients that fosters equity, fair treatment and respect for social and cultural diversity and that is free from abuse or neglect, empowering all clients to uphold their rights.

Guidestar's Client Safety and Wellbeing Policy

Guidestar believes that clients who use and participate in services, should expect to receive those services that meet their needs and that no preventable harm occurs. To achieve this objective, Guidestar is committed to upholding a zero tolerance for the abuse and neglect of all clients including children, people with a disability, people with a mental health issue, older people and other vulnerable groups.

Guidestar will support and empower clients and their carers to report abuse, inappropriate behaviour or concerns about their safety through the development and maintenance of simple and accessible processes.

Guidestar has a zero tolerance approach to abuse and neglect. There are many different forms of abuse including child, domestic violence and elder abuse. Since Guidestar deal with people of all ages from a wide range of family, cultural and socio-economic backgrounds, at times we may encounter situations involving abuse.

A Guidestar employee member may become aware of abuse of clients in a variety of ways. They may be informed by the client, they may observe physical or behavioural evidence of abuse or the abuse may be reported by family members, friends or service providers. It is also important to note that victims may, at times, be reluctant to admit to the abuse, be unable to inform employee or they may be unaware that the abuse is happening.

Guidestar, in its commitment to providing a safe environment for all clients will:

- Act to prevent abuse and neglect and to uphold the legal and human rights of all Guidestar clients.
- Take all practical and appropriate steps to manage risks and prevent abuse and neglect of clients.
- Ensure safeguards are in place to prevent abuse and neglect from occurring by:
 - Providing information to clients in accessible formats on rights, and on protection against abuse.
 - Providing information and awareness training to employee on the vulnerability of clients to abuse and neglect.
 - Maintaining recruitment screening processes to ensure appropriate employee selection.
 - Maintaining robust human resources processes to ensure appropriate employee supervision and reporting.
 - Providing employees and contractors with clear guidelines on how to deal with allegations of abuse and neglect including reporting, investigation and management.
 - Providing employees who have legal mandatory reporting obligations with specific guidance and instruction to support them fulfilling those professional obligations.
 - Confirming that all mandatory reporting obligations are fulfilled i.e. Elder Abuse and Child Abuse.
- Support clients to access complaint mechanisms within Guidestar and externally.

Complaints, Compliments & Feedback

Making a complaint or providing feedback to Guidestar

To make a complaint or raise a concern you may have about our service, please contact us by;

Phone: (03) 9994 3345, or

Email: contact.us@guidestarlifec.com.au or

Fill out the online Feedback Form on our website:

<https://guidestarlifec.com.au/guidestar-welcomes-your-feedback/>

Guidestar is committed to ensuring that all feedback and complaints are acknowledged within a 3-working day time frame and resolution of complaints is addressed within a 21-working day time frame.

NDIS Quality & Safeguards Commission

People with disability have the right to complain about the services they receive. Most NDIS providers do their best to provide quality supports and services to people with disability, but issues can occur.

If you have a concern about Guidestar supports or services, it is important that you talk about it.

Complaints are important—they can help us understand what is important to people with disability and improve the quality of services we provide, so your complaint can help other people too.

If you feel comfortable, you are encouraged to raise your concern or complaint with Guidestar first, as this is often the best way to have your issue resolved quickly.

You can contact the NDIS Commission on -

Phone: 1800 035 544 (free call from landlines),

TTY: 133 677 - Interpreters can be arranged

National Relay Service and ask for 1800 035 544 or

Complete a complaint contact form available from:

<https://www.ndiscommission.gov.au/about/complaints-feedback/complaints>

Additional Information

Mental Health Complaints Commissioner

You have the right to speak up or complain about a public mental health service, please see below for the Mental Health Complaints Commissioner's contact details.

Phone:

1800 246 054 (free from landlines), or
(03) 9032 3328

National Relay Service:

www.relayservice.gov.au and then
1800 246 054

Address:

Level 26, 570 Bourke Street, Melbourne
VIC 3000

Website:

www.mhcc.vic.gov.au

Email:

To lodge a concern or complaint about a service: help@mhcc.vic.gov.au

For general enquiries:

info@mhcc.vic.gov.au

Office of the Public Advocate (OPA)

The Office of the Public Advocate safeguards the rights and interests of people with a disability. For information on their services, advocacy, guardianship and administration, and powers of attorney, please see below for their contact details.

Phone:

1300 309 337

TTY:

1300 305 612

Address:

Level 1, 204 Lygon Street, Carlton VIC
3053

Website:

www.publicadvocate.vic.gov.au

Email:

opa_advice@justice.vic.gov.au

Disability Advocacy Resource Unit (DARU)

For further information about advocacy or to find a disability advocacy service, please see below for the Disability Advocacy Resource Unit contact information.

Phone:
(03) 9639 5807

Email:
admin@daru.org.au

Address:
Located at VCOSS
Level 8, 128 Exhibition Street, Melbourne
VIC 3000

Website:
www.daru.org.au

Contact Guidestar

Address

Guidestar (Guidestar Life Pty Ltd)
804-806 Heidelberg Road
Alphington Vic 3078

Phone

To talk to someone at Guidestar about how we can best support you and how we can assist achieve your goals, please contact us on;

(03) 9994 3345

Email

contact.us@guidestarlifecomm.au

Website

www.guidestarlifecomm.au

Social Media

You can also rate us on www.clickability.com.au